TSIMUN I Conference
Country: Germany
Delegate: Jules Kitto-Astrop
Committee: United Nations Commission on Science and Technology for Development (CSTD)
Agenda: The Question of Establishing Ethical Frameworks for the Global Use of Artificial Intelligence

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Globally, nations continue to address the impacts of artificial intelligence on safety and privacy, health and security, or environmental depreciation. As one of the pioneers of the EU AI Act, Germany advocated for a UN facilitated international template, rather than fragmented nation and issue specific legislation. The question of establishing ethical frameworks for global AI use requires the consideration of; accountability, privacy, transparency, and bias. Germany believes that in order to address these aspects, different AI presences (and lack thereof) must engage in international consultations to prevent an AI divide, simultaneously enabling a comprehensive understanding of current circumstances and future prospects. The delegation of Germany believes that all AI should be created with the purpose of being a productive and safe tool for all, free of bias and surveillance – supporting Germany's principles of human-centric AI, focused on ensuring tools are created for the greater good, provided alongside training, and are not capable of disproportionately benefiting certain demographics.

The Federal Republic of Germany firmly believes that AI can pose incredible potential for technological development without compromising people's ability to think about, design, create, and pursue unique innovations that can and will change the world, like AI has. Though Germany supports the development and implementation of AI, we recognize that we are responsible for the data and impact that these innovations have on society. Thus, Germany's role was crucial in the creation and implementation of the EU AI Act, by advocating for frameworks rather than technical barriers, and emphasizing European-made systems as a form of cultural sovereignty. Notably, the EU AI Act clearly highlights the differences in impact and risk between different AI systems, placing a focus on high-risk systems (e.g. healthcare and justice). Outside of the EU AI Act, Germany prioritizes security-by-design and human oversight in AI. To remain cautious while supporting the implementation of restricted biometric technology, Germany has developed legislation, permitting use of such equipment for travel security measures and targeted searches of missing or wanted persons *(Federal Ministry of the Interior and Community)*. Further proving Germany's key role in this issue, Germany is also the first nation in the world to develop legislation around autonomous vehicles, with Level 4 autonomous vehicles permitted in designated surveillance areas. We view this as a foundation for global ethical frameworks, proving innovation and accountability can coexist. Germany believes the concept of human-centric AI means protecting human dignity through the provision of explanations for AI decisions and outputs. By using Open Source AI or providing comprehensive and accurate details of the decision making process, Germany encourages nations to invest in digital sovereignty, enabling the Global South's use of AI. More recently, Germany has leveraged billions in donations from private and public funds to support the development of "AI Made in Germany", a new quality label that proves safety and reliability through the public awareness of guidelines and AI systems, Germany relies on the Federal Network Agency (BNetzA) to maintain standards, provide oversight, and incident handling.

In the present, Germany, while supportive of the current legislation, believes more must be done to bridge the gap between high-tech and low-tech nations with specific focus on the cultural, environmental, and geopolitical risks posed by AI. Germany believes that the optimal strategy for addressing AI ethics relies on several interconnected initiatives; regional training data review boards monitored by the UN, safety standards, and reparations for remote AI server use. Germany proposes the development of 10 UN regional bodies responsible for the review of AI training data (upon request or errors) to ensure cultural sovereignty and data protection, any systems approved by any one of the 10 regional bodies may be implemented in other regions after a brief individual review to prevent cultural bias or inaccuracy. Secondly, Germany supports safety standards with guidelines prohibiting the collection of data from non-signed users and the development of a secondary algorithm required for all AI systems. Automated Data Pruning determines what of the data provided is beneficial to keeping – in order to minimize environmental impact and prevent unnecessary data hoarding as supported by GDPR principles *(European Parliament and Council of the European Union)*. Finally the concept of reparations for the environmental impact of AI and the use of less developed countries for cheaper server hosting is seen as a must by Germany. Germany believes that AI systems should benefit everyone and therefore proposes standards for remote AI server use; €0.044 per kilowatt-hour to the hosting nation, as well as a fee to UNEP of 1% of the annual revenue, every year to rectify the environmental impacts and work towards sustainable AI use. Germany also believes in the provision of a one-time fee of €1 million to a national AI/technological institution of their choice to compensate for the lack of data sharing. The Federal Republic of Germany remains eager to address these issues while considering the nuanced perspectives of the CSTD.

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